IT board report: September 2026

Northwind Freight (fictional) | Prepared by the IT Manager | FY2026/27, month 6

AMBER
Overall status

All figures in this example are invented for a fictional company. Targets shown are examples, not benchmarks.

1. Headline

Services were stable this month and spend is on plan year to date. Cloud hosting is the main pressure on the full-year forecast, one project has slipped by a month, and two critical vulnerabilities remain open. Overall status is Amber.

2. Service performance

99.93%
Core platform availability
Target 99.9% (example)

1
Priority 1 incidents
Target 2 or fewer (example)

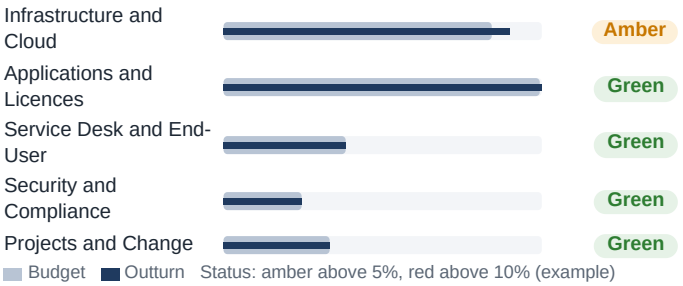
94%
Tickets resolved within SLA
Target 95% (example)

4.4 / 5
User satisfaction (CSAT)
Target 4.3 (example)

3. Spend against budget

Year to date **£664,259** against **£665,000** budget (-0.1%). Full-year outturn **£1,343,859** against **£1,314,000** (+2.3%). Outturn split: CapEx £434,499, OpEx £909,360.

Cost centre	FY budget	YTD actual	FY outturn	Variance
Infrastructure and Cloud	£396k	£221k	£423k	+6.9%
Applications and Licences	£468k	£234k	£471k	+0.6%
Service Desk and End-User	£180k	£90k	£180k	0.0%
Security and Compliance	£114k	£57k	£114k	0.0%
Projects and Change	£156k	£62k	£156k	0.0%
Total	**£1,314k**	**£664k**	**£1,344k**	**+2.3%**



Positive variance is an overspend. Cloud hosting alone is forecast £26,460 (about 12 percent) over its line budget. Scanning spend is behind plan year to date because of the delivery delay and is forecast to catch up by December.

4. Major projects

Project	Status	Budget	Update	Next milestone
Warehouse scanning rollout	Amber	£96,000	Hardware delivery arrived a month late. Go-live moves from November to December. Budget unchanged.	Go-live, Dec 2026
Data platform pilot	Green	£60,000	Pilot environment built and first data sets loaded. Spend on plan.	Pilot review, Jan 2027
Cloud cost optimisation review	Green	Within run cost	Usage analysis under way. Findings and options due in October.	Findings, Oct 2026
Annual disaster recovery test	Green	Within run cost	Test plan agreed with the business. Includes a measured restore test.	Test, Nov 2026

5. Top risks

ID	Risk	Score	Rating
R-002	Ransomware entering through a phishing email	15	Critical
R-001	Cloud hosting cost grows faster than forecast	12	High
R-004	Key-person dependency for integration knowledge	12	High
R-009	Backup restore not tested within the last 12 months	12	High

Score = likelihood (1 to 5) x impact (1 to 5).

6. Security posture

Measure	Result	Target	Status
Accounts protected by multi-factor authentication	**96%**	100% (example)	Amber
Critical patches applied within 14 days	**91%**	95% (example)	Amber
Open critical vulnerabilities	**2**	0 (example)	Amber
Phishing exercise click rate	**4.1%**	under 5% (example)	Green
Major security incidents	**0**	0 (example)	Green

7. Decisions requested

1. **Note the forecast overspend and agree the response.** Full-year outturn is £1,343,859 against a budget of £1,314,000 (+2.3%), driven by cloud hosting. Agree that IT completes the optimisation review and returns with options in November before any budget change is requested.
2. **Approve the preferred managed service desk supplier.** Vendor B ranked first on the weighted scorecard (4.30 out of 5; next best 3.55). Approve moving to contract and security review. The decision memo is attached.
3. **Agree the new warehouse scanning go-live date.** Approve a December 2026 go-live outside the peak trading weeks, with a phased site rollout as the fallback.